

COURSE 2A - OPTIONAL

PL-300 CERTIFICATION SUPPLEMENT

PL1-PL8 BEGINNER-FIRST TEACHING BOOK - RC1

Current objective audit -> domain assessment -> original 40Q -> repair -> readiness decision

THIS BOOK IS YOUR TEACHER

Verified against Microsoft's live English PL-300 study guide on 2026-09-11. Certification does not block C2A or DE route.

This book is your teacher

PL-300 is supplementary certification preparation. It never blocks Course 2A completion or the direct C2B/C3 route. Study one unit at a time and verify current Microsoft objectives before paying for the exam.

Daily lesson loop

1) Why it matters -> 2) what you learn -> 3) prerequisite -> 4) picture it in your head -> 5) new words -> 6) watch / visual source -> 7) follow with me once -> 8) expected result -> 9) why it worked -> 10) mistakes -> 11) recovery -> 12) independent task -> 13) validate -> 14) teach it back -> 15) protected review + changed retry -> 16) evidence / mastery + exact next route.

Certification boundary

Official Microsoft sources outrank this internal book when objectives change. The course teaches how to verify the live objective version and repair gaps; it does not reproduce exam questions or promise a pass.

Attempt protection

Internal assessments and changed retests are closed-book. Save your response before opening protected rationale. Repeated memorization is not accepted as mastery evidence.

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Every supplementary PL unit has its own beginner-first lesson route

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Prerequisite and status separation

Certification evidence must never rewrite course or DE status

PREREQUISITES

Most PL skills were taught in C2-01, C2-03, C2-04 and C2-07. PL2-PL5 are assessment/repair layers, not a second compressed replacement curriculum. When a gap appears, route back to the relevant beginner-first teaching.

CORE C2A STATUS

CAP1-CAP14 + Final Gate + integrity controls. Can be PASS even when PL-300 readiness is Developing or Not Pursued.

DE STATUS

Direct DA->DE path uses C2B/C3. PL-300 does not unlock C3. A Power BI certification does not prove Data Engineering readiness.

EXAM-SOURCE RULE

Immediately before paying/sitting, re-open the official PL-300 study guide and official exam/practice pages. If the effective date/objectives changed, freeze the new baseline and refresh the internal mapping before trusting this book.

Assessment / repair route

Diagnostic first, targeted repair second, changed proof third



ORDER

Do PL1 -> PL2-PL5 domain evidence -> PL6 40Q. Only then open protected rationale. Use PL7 for objective-level repair and a changed retest. Take the current Microsoft Practice Assessment after repair. Use PL8 to decide Ready / Repair / Defer.

INTERNAL HEURISTIC

For PL8 only: $\geq 80\%$ overall and $\geq 70\%$ each internal domain on fresh/changed evidence, plus no unresolved conceptual blind spot. This is not Microsoft's score model.

OFFICIAL SIGNAL

Microsoft Practice Assessment is free, provides rationales/score breakdown and is updated with certifications. It remains diagnostic; Microsoft says it is not a replacement for training or product experience.

PL1 - Current exam objectives audit

1. Why it matters

Certification objectives change. Studying an old screenshot can waste time or omit new features. PL1 teaches you to verify the current official English skills before paying for or scheduling the exam.

2. What you are learning

Audit the live Microsoft PL-300 guide for effective date, four domain weights, changed objectives and audience profile; map changes to Course 2A evidence; keep certification status separate from course completion.

3. Prerequisite / what you already know

None beyond basic navigation. This is the first PL unit and remains supplementary.

4. Picture it in your head

Mental model

Imagine the certification task as this path: Official guide -> Effective date -> Weights -> Changed skills -> Course map -> Decision. Keep objective version, evidence and readiness decision separate so a course result never gets confused with an official exam result.

5. New words before we use them

Skills measured: Official objectives describing what the exam can assess. Effective date: Date from which a stated objective version applies to the English exam. Domain weight: Approximate share/range of exam emphasis assigned to a skill area.

6. Watch / visual source

Official PL-300 source route. Use the live study guide as authority; the Exam Readiness or Practice Assessment link is a companion diagnostic/visual.
<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/pl-300>

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-prepare-the-data>

After opening a source: return to this unit and complete the internal diagnostic/repair task from your own evidence. The external page is not your submission.

7. Follow with me once

Teacher demonstration - complete this once, then close it before the changed task.

- 1 Open the official study guide. Confirm the heading says skills measured as of April 20, 2026.
- 2 Record weights: Prepare 25-30%, Model 25-30%, Visualize/Analyze 25-30%, Manage/Secure 15-20%.
- 3 Record audience expectations: meaningful business value, understandable visualization, self-service enablement, business stakeholder requirements and collaboration with analytics/data engineers.
- 4 Scan current objectives for newer items such as DirectLake, calculation groups, visual calculations and Copilot-related report/narrative tasks. Do not assume an older video covers every current bullet.
- 5 Write your exam decision: Not pursuing / Maybe later / Preparing. This choice does not change C2A completion or DE-route eligibility.

8. What you should see / be able to say

Expected result

A dated objective-audit sheet and current course-coverage map.

9. Why it worked

Reasoning

The certification plan is anchored to the live source instead of a stale internal book. Professional boundary: Re-run PL1 immediately before exam payment/sitting because Microsoft exams update periodically and localized versions can lag the English update.

10. Common beginner mistakes

1. Treat course percentages as Microsoft scaled score. | 2. Pay before checking objective version. | 3. Assume an older four-part video is complete current coverage. | 4. Mark PL-300 PASS because C2A is complete.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

Recovery

Return to the official study guide; copy only the effective date/domain headings and paraphrase changed skills into your audit sheet.

12. Now you do a small version alone

Fresh independent task

Complete PL1 objective-audit workbook with verified date, weights, current gaps and whether you intend to take the exam.

13. Validate your result

Validation

All four weights/effective date match the live official guide; every gap points to a current objective, not a rumor/video.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain without reading

Explain why a good certification course must be able to say 'this internal page may be stale; verify the official guide'.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Attempt protection

No answer key is needed. Changed retry: pretend Microsoft publishes a new effective date; identify which internal maps/assessments must be refreshed.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Mastery evidence

Dated objective audit + current coverage/gap map + exam decision. Official PL-300 study guide Then continue to PL2.

PL2 - Prepare Data assessment

1. Why it matters

Prepare Data questions are not just 'which button'. You must choose connection/storage modes, identify data-quality issues and shape data into reliable fact/dimension inputs.

2. What you are learning

Assess current Prepare Data skills: data sources/settings/privacy/credentials; DirectLake/DirectQuery/Import; parameters; profiling/cleaning/errors; types/transforms; semi-structured data; fact/dimension preparation; reference/duplicate, merge/append, keys and load settings.

3. Prerequisite / what you already know

C2-01 Power Query plus related C2-03/C2-05/C2-07 data handling.

4. Picture it in your head

Mental model

Imagine the certification task as this path: Connect -> Profile -> Clean -> Transform -> Shape model tables -> Load. Keep objective version, evidence and readiness decision separate so a course result never gets confused with an official exam result.

5. New words before we use them

DirectLake: Power BI/Fabric storage mode that queries Delta data in OneLake with behavior distinct from Import/DirectQuery. Privacy level: Power Query data-source privacy setting affecting how data can be combined. Reference query: New query based on the result/steps of another query rather than an independent copy of its steps.

6. Watch / visual source

Official PL-300 source route. Use the live study guide as authority; the Exam Readiness or Practice Assessment link is a companion diagnostic/visual.

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/pl-300>

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-prepare-the-data>

After opening a source: return to this unit and complete the internal diagnostic/repair task from your own evidence. The external page is not your submission.

7. Follow with me once

Teacher demonstration - complete this once, then close it before the changed task.

- 1 A model needs interactive performance and source is a Fabric OneLake semantic-ready Delta table: consider DirectLake; explain why mode choice depends on supported source/behavior, not fashion.
- 2 CSV columns arrive as text including dates/numbers: profile errors/nulls, assign types deliberately and keep rejected/unexpected cases visible.
- 3 Nested JSON must become a table: expand/normalize while declaring output grain and retaining a key.
- 4 Two monthly files with same schema are combined vertically: append. Customer attributes joined by CustomerID: merge after key uniqueness/cardinality check.
- 5 Disable load for staging/helper queries where appropriate; keep final fact/dimension tables loaded according to model design.

8. What you should see / be able to say

Expected result

You can explain the operation and its reason before naming a Power Query control.

9. Why it worked

Reasoning

Current objective bullets are connected to data contracts/grain rather than memorized UI paths. Professional boundary: Current exam can assess general-availability features and commonly used Preview features; use live docs if a feature behavior changed.

10. Common beginner mistakes

1. DirectLake always best. | 2. Duplicate and Reference are synonyms. | 3. Merge versus Append confused. | 4. Convert errors to null without investigating source quality.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

Recovery

Ask: connect how? inspect quality? transform rows/columns? combine side-by-side or vertically? which result should load?

12. Now you do a small version alone

Fresh independent task

Complete the Prepare section of the internal practice assessment and one hands-on mini-task using dirty CSV + JSON from prior modules.

13. Validate your result

Validation

Every answer can be justified from data shape/quality/model need; hands-on output includes grain/key/type checks.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain without reading

Explain Merge versus Append and Reference versus Duplicate without using menu-location language.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Attempt protection

Open protected assessment rationale only after the closed-book attempt. Changed retry uses different source mode/data-shape conditions.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Mastery evidence

PL2 domain score + error log + one hands-on Prepare artifact + changed retry. Official study guide + Prepare the Data exam-readiness video Then continue to PL3.

PL3 - Model Data assessment

1. Why it matters

Model questions test whether you understand relationships/evaluation context and can choose DAX/model structures safely, not whether you remember a formula by shape.

2. What you are learning

Assess table/column properties, role-playing dimensions, relationship cardinality/filter direction, common Date table, calculated columns/tables, DAX measures/CALCULATE/time intelligence/statistics/semi-additive/quick measures/calculation groups and performance analysis.

3. Prerequisite / what you already know

C2-03 professional modeling and C2-04 DAX/performance.

4. Picture it in your head

Mental model

Imagine the certification task as this path: Tables -> Relationships -> Date -> DAX -> Performance -> Validate. Keep objective version, evidence and readiness decision separate so a course result never gets confused with an official exam result.

5. New words before we use them

Calculation group: Model object that centralizes reusable calculation transformations such as time calculations. Semi-additive: Measure additive across some dimensions but not across time or another dimension. DAX query view: Power BI feature used to write/run DAX queries and inspect/test model behavior.

6. Watch / visual source

Official PL-300 source route. Use the live study guide as authority; the Exam Readiness or Practice Assessment link is a companion diagnostic/visual.

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/pl-300>

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-model-the-data>

After opening a source: return to this unit and complete the internal diagnostic/repair task from your own evidence. The external page is not your submission.

7. Follow with me once

Teacher demonstration - complete this once, then close it before the changed task.

- 1 Customer-to-Sales is one-to-many when Customer key is unique. Many-to-many should not be the first fix for duplicate dimension keys.
- 2 Role-playing Date: one Date table can support Order Date/Ship Date with relationship/measure strategy; define which relationship is active.
- 3 Use a measure for filter-context-responsive business totals; calculated columns store row-context results at refresh and increase model size.
- 4 CALCULATE modifies filter context; time intelligence needs a correct Date model/definitions. Explain business contract before formula.
- 5 Use Performance Analyzer and DAX query view to investigate slow visuals/measures; remove unnecessary rows/columns and excessive granularity where justified.

8. What you should see / be able to say

Expected result

Model answers cite grain/cardinality/context/performance rather than memorized syntax alone.

9. Why it worked

Reasoning

The technical concept and the business model contract stay connected. Professional boundary: Calculation groups and newer DAX/model tooling should be learned conceptually plus hands-on if your Power BI version supports them.

10. Common beginner mistakes

1. Bidirectional everywhere. | 2. Calculated column for every KPI. | 3. Date intelligence on incomplete/ambiguous date model. | 4. Optimize only visuals while model granularity is the real issue.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

Recovery

Draw tables/keys/relationship direction first; then state whether calculation must respond to filter context or be stored per row.

12. Now you do a small version alone

Fresh independent task

Take PL3 domain questions closed-book and recreate one role-playing-date + CALCULATE/filter-context test from your C2A evidence.

13. Validate your result

Validation

Model diagram/key uniqueness and DAX expected-output tests are saved; wrong answers are mapped to exact objective bullets.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain without reading

Explain why a measure and calculated column can both return numbers but behave differently.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Attempt protection

Protected rationale only after attempt. Changed retry alters cardinality/date role/filter requirement.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Mastery evidence

Official study guide + Model the Data exam-readiness video Then continue to PL4.

PL4 - Visualize & Analyze assessment

1. Why it matters

A visualization question is often a business-choice question. You need to know which visual/interaction helps the user, how filters/navigation behave, and how current Power BI analytical features support patterns/trends.

2. What you are learning

Assess visual choice/configuration, themes/conditional formatting/filtering, report pages, paginated report choice, visual calculations, bookmarks/tooltips/interactions/navigation/mobile/accessibility/personalization/auto-refresh plus Analyze, grouping/binning/clustering, AI visuals, reference lines/error bars/forecasting/anomalies and Copilot-supported tasks.

3. Prerequisite / what you already know

C2-04 Reporting & DAX and C2-08 executive communication.

4. Picture it in your head

Mental model

Imagine the certification task as this path: Choose visual -> Configure -> Story/usability -> Analyze -> Accessibility -> Validate. Keep objective version, evidence and readiness decision separate so a course result never gets confused with an official exam result.

5. New words before we use them

Visual calculation: Calculation defined at the visual level using the visual's data/structure. Paginated report: Pixel-perfect multi-page report format optimized for printing/export/detail layouts. Accessibility: Design that supports users with visual, motor or cognitive needs through labels, contrast, keyboard/reading order and appropriate alternatives.

6. Watch / visual source

Official PL-300 source route. Use the live study guide as authority; the Exam Readiness or Practice Assessment link is a companion diagnostic/visual.

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<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-visualize-and-analyze-the-data>

After opening a source: return to this unit and complete the internal diagnostic/repair task from your own evidence. The external page is not your submission.

7. Follow with me once

Teacher demonstration - complete this once, then close it before the changed task.

- 1 Trend over time: line chart with clear date grain/units; category ranking: bar; exact long printable detail: consider paginated report.
- 2 Use conditional formatting only when threshold meaning is defined; do not let decorative color imply severity.
- 3 Bookmarks/buttons/drillthrough/tooltips should support a user path; test interactions and filter persistence so KPI meaning stays clear.
- 4 Mobile layout and accessibility are design requirements, not afterthoughts. Record alt text/reading order/contrast where applicable.
- 5 Use forecasting/anomaly/AI/Copilot features only when the method/question fits, and verify generated narrative/content against underlying model.

8. What you should see / be able to say

Expected result

Visual/feature selections are justified by decision, data type, usability and verification.

9. Why it worked

Reasoning

You choose Power BI features as communication/analysis tools, not exam vocabulary. Professional boundary: New visual/Copilot features can change faster than core design principles. Verify current availability/licensing before relying on them.

10. Common beginner mistakes

1. Pie chart because category question says share. | 2. Copilot narrative accepted without checking facts. | 3. Auto page refresh used despite source/decision not needing it. | 4. Mobile/accessibility skipped because desktop looks good.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

Recovery

Start with user question -> data structure -> visual task -> interaction/usability -> validation.

12. Now you do a small version alone

Fresh independent task

Take PL4 questions closed-book and audit one prior report against visual choice, interaction, mobile/accessibility and analytical-feature objectives.

13. Validate your result

Validation

Each feature has a user/question reason and expected behavior; Copilot/AI output is independently verified if used.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain without reading

Explain why choosing a visual is part of analysis, not just formatting.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Attempt protection

Open rationale only after attempt. Changed retry switches audience/device/interaction requirement.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Mastery evidence

PL4 score + report audit + changed retry + objective gap map. Official study guide + Visualize and Analyze exam-readiness video Then continue to PL5.

PL5 - Manage & Secure assessment

1. Why it matters

A report is not enterprise-ready just because it is published. Manage/Secure tests workspace/app/distribution, refresh/gateway and layered access/governance decisions.

2. What you are learning

Assess workspace/app/item management, dashboards/distribution/subscriptions/alerts/endorsement, gateway/scheduled refresh, workspace/item/semantic-model access, RLS roles/group membership and sensitivity labels.

3. Prerequisite / what you already know

C2-07 enterprise BI and C2-04 RLS/lifecycle.

4. Picture it in your head

Mental model

Imagine the certification task as this path: Workspace -> Distribute -> Refresh/gateway -> Access -> RLS -> Sensitivity. Keep objective version, evidence and readiness decision separate so a course result never gets confused with an official exam result.

5. New words before we use them

Item-level access: Permission to a specific Fabric/Power BI item without broad workspace editing rights. RLS group membership: Assignment of users/groups to row-level-security roles controlling model row visibility. Endorsement: Promoted/certified trust signal under organizational governance.

6. Watch / visual source

Official PL-300 source route. Use the live study guide as authority; the Exam Readiness or Practice Assessment link is a companion diagnostic/visual.
<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/pl-300>

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-manage-and-secure-power-bi>

After opening a source: return to this unit and complete the internal diagnostic/repair task from your own evidence. The external page is not your submission.

7. Follow with me once

Teacher demonstration - complete this once, then close it before the changed task.

- 1 Builders collaborate in a workspace; consumers normally use app/item/model routes rather than Contributor by convenience.
- 2 Choose app/direct sharing/distribution based on audience and tenant/licensing policy; endorsement identifies trusted content but does not grant permission.
- 3 For on-prem/private sources, identify gateway need, credentials and scheduled refresh; technical success still needs business freshness validation.
- 4 Layer workspace role, item/model access and RLS. RLS restricts rows for authorized users; it does not replace all other permissions.
- 5 Apply sensitivity labels according to organizational policy and verify external/export behavior as current tenant settings require.

8. What you should see / be able to say

Expected result

Security/operations answers separate resource access, data visibility, refresh connectivity and governance.

9. Why it worked

Reasoning

Each control solves a different risk rather than using Admin/RLS as universal fixes. Professional boundary: Exact tenant/license/security behavior can vary. Use current Microsoft docs before production configuration.

10. Common beginner mistakes

1. RLS means workspace Admin is safe. | 2. Gateway is a performance booster. | 3. Certified content can be viewed by anyone. | 4. Personal credentials used as the default production refresh identity.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

Recovery

For any question write Identity -> Resource -> Action -> Permission; then Source -> Connectivity -> Credential -> Refresh -> Freshness.

12. Now you do a small version alone

Fresh independent task

Take PL5 domain questions and complete one workspace/app/access/gateway/refresh/RLS design from C2-07 fixtures.

13. Validate your result

Validation

Least privilege, source connectivity, schedule/freshness, RLS and sensitivity assumptions are explicit.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain without reading

Explain workspace access versus item/model access versus RLS in plain language.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Attempt protection

Protected rationale only after attempt. Changed retry alters persona, source location and distribution requirement.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Mastery evidence

Official study guide + Manage and Secure exam-readiness video Then continue to PL6.

PL6 - Microsoft-style internal practice assessment

1. Why it matters

A practice test is useful only when it reveals reasoning gaps. Memorizing an answer key or converting an internal percent into Microsoft's scaled score creates false confidence.

2. What you are learning

Take the 40-question original Course 2A assessment under closed-book conditions; calculate overall/domain performance; review rationales only afterward; classify each error as knowledge, reading, scenario or hands-on gap.

3. Prerequisite / what you already know

PL1-PL5 first pass. This assessment uses original course-written questions, not copied Microsoft exam questions.

4. Picture it in your head

Mental model

Imagine the certification task as this path: Closed book -> 40 original items -> Domain score -> Rationale -> Gap map -> Changed retest. Keep objective version, evidence and readiness decision separate so a course result never gets confused with an official exam result.

5. New words before we use them

Scaled score: Microsoft exam reporting scale; internal course percentages are not directly convertible to it. Distractor: Plausible but incorrect option designed to test precise reasoning. Error taxonomy: Classification of why an answer was wrong so repair targets the cause.

6. Watch / visual source

Official PL-300 source route. Use the live study guide as authority; the Exam Readiness or Practice Assessment link is a companion diagnostic/visual.

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/pl-300>

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/practice-assessments-for-microsoft-certifications>

After opening a source: return to this unit and complete the internal diagnostic/repair task from your own evidence. The external page is not your submission.

7. Follow with me once

Teacher demonstration - complete this once, then close it before the changed task.

- 1 Take all 40 questions closed-book without opening protected rationale or searching.
- 2 Record confidence High/Medium/Low beside each response; low-confidence correct answers still deserve review.
- 3 Score by domain separately: 11 Prepare, 11 Model, 11 Visualize/Analyze, 7 Manage/Secure.
- 4 Open protected rationale. For every wrong/low-confidence item record objective, why your answer failed and one hands-on/doc repair action.
- 5 Do not repeat the same 40 questions immediately for 'improved score'. Repair first, then use changed retest or official Practice Assessment.

8. What you should see / be able to say

Expected result

A domain-specific gap map rather than one vanity score.

9. Why it worked

Reasoning

Assessment becomes a diagnostic tool instead of a memorization exercise. Professional boundary: Microsoft's free Practice Assessment is the authoritative external readiness check and may be retaken; it is not a replacement for training or hands-on product experience.

10. Common beginner mistakes

1. Look up answers while testing. | 2. 80% overall hides a 40% security domain. | 3. Retake immediately after reading answers. | 4. Claim internal 80% means Microsoft pass score 700.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

Recovery

If a question feels ambiguous, state the scenario assumption you used; after review compare it with the tested objective.

12. Now you do a small version alone

Fresh independent task

Complete C2_09_PL300_40Q_PRACTICE_ASSESSMENT_RC1.xlsx closed-book and save response/confidence/domain summary.

13. Validate your result

Validation

Protected review timestamp is after first attempt; domain scoring works; each wrong/low-confidence item has a repair target.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain without reading

Explain why a wrong answer with a clear repair plan can be more useful than a lucky correct answer.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Attempt protection

Use C2_09_PL300_40Q_REVIEW_PROTECTED_RC1.pdf only after submission. Then take the changed internal retest after repair.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Mastery evidence

40Q response sheet + domain scores + confidence/error taxonomy + repair log. Original course assessment + Microsoft free Practice Assessment
Then continue to PL7.

PL7 - Weak-area repair

1. Why it matters

Re-reading every course module after one weak PL domain wastes time. Certification repair should be narrow: identify the exact current objective, rebuild the mental model, do one hands-on task and answer a changed scenario.

2. What you are learning

Convert PL6/official Practice Assessment results into objective-level repair; use official docs/current course material; require hands-on evidence where possible; close the loop with changed questions rather than answer-key repetition.

3. Prerequisite / what you already know

PL6 completed honestly or a current official Practice Assessment result.

4. Picture it in your head

Mental model

Imagine the certification task as this path: Gap -> Objective -> Mini lesson -> Hands-on -> Changed question -> Evidence. Keep objective version, evidence and readiness decision separate so a course result never gets confused with an official exam result.

5. New words before we use them

Weak area: Specific objective/concept where evidence or confidence is below readiness. Targeted repair: Focused relearning/practice on the failed competency. Changed retest: New scenario testing the same competency without reusing the original answer.

6. Watch / visual source

Official PL-300 source route. Use the live study guide as authority; the Exam Readiness or Practice Assessment link is a companion diagnostic/visual.
<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/practice-assessments-for-microsoft-certifications>

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/pl-300>

After opening a source: return to this unit and complete the internal diagnostic/repair task from your own evidence. The external page is not your submission.

7. Follow with me once

Teacher demonstration - complete this once, then close it before the changed task.

- 1 Error: chose RLS as a substitute for workspace/item permission. Map to current Manage/Secure access objectives.
- 2 Rebuild mental model: user needs permission to access the item/model; RLS then restricts rows within the model.
- 3 Hands-on/design task: create builder/manager/auditor matrix with workspace/item/model/RLS controls.
- 4 Changed question: manager should consume only regional data through an app; choose the minimum access/security path and explain.
- 5 Save evidence and mark objective Repaired only if changed task is correct without looking at the original rationale.

8. What you should see / be able to say

Expected result

A repair log where each weak objective has explanation, task, changed proof and status.

9. Why it worked

Reasoning

You repair the underlying concept rather than memorize one question wording. Professional boundary: If your Power BI tenant/version lacks a feature, use current docs plus a deterministic design task and mark live hands-on as Environment Blocked rather than faking it.

10. Common beginner mistakes

1. Rewatch 8 hours for one weak bullet. | 2. Retake same assessment until memory raises score. | 3. Use random exam-dump sites. | 4. Mark repaired after reading rationale only.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

Recovery

One weak item -> one official objective -> one mental model -> one hands-on task -> one changed retest.

12. Now you do a small version alone

Fresh independent task

Repair every PL6/official weak area and complete the 20-question changed retest without opening prior answer review.

13. Validate your result

Validation

Every repaired objective has new evidence; no same-question memorization; unresolved gaps remain visible.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain without reading

Explain why changed retest is stronger evidence than repeating the same answer choices.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Attempt protection

Use changed-retest protected rationale only after submission. Repeat targeted repair for remaining objective gaps.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Mastery evidence

Weak-area repair log + hands-on artifacts + 20Q changed-retest results. Official study guide/current docs + relevant prior C2A module Then continue to PL8.

PL8 - Certification readiness Gate

1. Why it matters

Certification readiness is a decision under uncertainty. One internal score, course completion or confidence feeling is not enough to justify paying for the exam.

2. What you are learning

Make a certification decision from current-objective audit, internal domain evidence, changed retest, official Microsoft Practice Assessment and hands-on confidence; keep the result separate from C2A completion and DE readiness.

3. Prerequisite / what you already know

PL1 current audit, PL6 diagnostic, PL7 repairs. Official Practice Assessment strongly recommended before payment.

4. Picture it in your head

Mental model

Imagine the certification task as this path: Objective audit -> Internal domains -> Official practice -> Hands-on -> Decision -> Exam plan. Keep objective version, evidence and readiness decision separate so a course result never gets confused with an official exam result.

5. New words before we use them

Readiness threshold: Internal evidence rule used to decide whether more preparation is needed; not Microsoft's official pass formula. Practice Assessment: Microsoft's free exam-preparation assessment with score breakdown/rationales. Exam decision: Ready to schedule/pay, continue repair, or defer certification without affecting course completion.

6. Watch / visual source

Official PL-300 source route. Use the live study guide as authority; the Exam Readiness or Practice Assessment link is a companion diagnostic/visual.

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/practice-assessments-for-microsoft-certifications>

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/pl-300>

After opening a source: return to this unit and complete the internal diagnostic/repair task from your own evidence. The external page is not your submission.

7. Follow with me once

Teacher demonstration - complete this once, then close it before the changed task.

- 1 Re-run PL1: confirm official English objective effective date/weights immediately before decision.
- 2 Internal evidence target: $\geq 80\%$ overall and $\geq 70\%$ in each internal domain on fresh/changed evidence, with no unresolved conceptual blind spot. This is a course readiness heuristic only.
- 3 Take current Microsoft Practice Assessment after repair; inspect domain/result rationale rather than chasing repeated score memory.
- 4 Confirm hands-on confidence across Power Query, model/DAX/reporting and workspace/refresh/security scenarios. Environment-blocked features are documented honestly.
- 5 Decision: READY TO SCHEDULE, CONTINUE TARGETED REPAIR, or DEFER. Record why. Never label C2A core incomplete because PL8 is not ready.

8. What you should see / be able to say

Expected result

A transparent exam-readiness decision with dated official-objective evidence and remaining gaps.

9. Why it worked

Reasoning

Multiple independent signals reduce false confidence from one repeated internal test. Professional boundary: Microsoft currently states that a score of 700 or greater is required to pass the real exam. That scaled score cannot be inferred from internal course percentages.

10. Common beginner mistakes

1. Course 2A complete = PL-300 ready. | 2. Internal 80% converted to official 700. | 3. Official practice repeatedly memorized until 100%. | 4. Paying because a discount/exam date creates pressure despite weak domain.

11. If you get stuck - recovery ladder

Recovery

If any domain is weak, do not restart all PL units. Return to PL7 for that objective and use a changed task.

12. Now you do a small version alone

Fresh independent task

Complete PL8 readiness record and choose READY / REPAIR / DEFER with evidence.

13. Validate your result

Validation

Objective audit is current; internal/official practice evidence is dated; hands-on gaps are explicit; course/DE statuses remain untouched.

14. Teach it back in your own words

Explain without reading

Explain why postponing an optional certification can be the correct professional decision while continuing your career path.

15. Protected review + changed fresh retry

Attempt protection

There is no hidden 'correct career choice'. The Gate checks evidence integrity. Revisit PL8 after targeted repair or objective updates.

16. Evidence / mastery + exact next route

Mastery evidence

Readiness record + current-objective audit + internal domain results + official Practice Assessment result + hands-on confidence map. Official PL-300 study guide + Microsoft Practice Assessment Then complete the readiness quick reference and certification readiness decision.

PL-300 readiness quick reference

Certification is optional; integrity is not

CURRENT VERIFIED BASELINE

Skills measured as of April 20, 2026. Prepare 25-30%; Model 25-30%; Visualize & Analyze 25-30%; Manage & Secure 15-20%. Real-exam passing requirement is a Microsoft scaled score of 700+, not an internal percentage conversion.

READY TO SCHEDULE ONLY WHEN

PL1 audit current; internal domains on fresh evidence meet the internal heuristic; weak areas repaired with changed tasks; current official Practice Assessment completed; hands-on confidence is real; exam cost/timing is acceptable to you.

REPAIR / DEFER WHEN

One domain remains conceptually weak; score is from memorized repeat; hands-on ability missing; current objectives changed; tenant limitations prevent useful practice; certification is not presently valuable enough to justify cost/time.

NEVER CHANGE THESE

PL-300 readiness cannot change CAP/Final Gate completion, promotion evidence strength, C2B entry or C3 unlock by itself. These are separate records.

Official PL-300 source / video registry

Live Microsoft sources control current certification behavior

PL1-PL8 - PL-300 Study Guide

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/resources/study-guides/pl-300>

Effective Apr 20 2026; four domains/weights; official objective source

PL1-PL8 - Microsoft Certification Practice Assessments

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/credentials/certifications/practice-assessments-for-microsoft-certifications>

Free external diagnostic; PL-300 is listed; rationales/score breakdown

PL1-PL2 - Exam Readiness - Prepare the Data

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-prepare-the-data>

Optional visual; older recording does not supersede current guide

PL3 - Exam Readiness - Model the Data

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-model-the-data>

Optional visual

PL4 - Exam Readiness - Visualize and Analyze

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-visualize-and-analyze-the-data>

Optional visual

PL5-PL8 - Exam Readiness - Manage and Secure Power BI

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/shows/exam-readiness-zone/preparing-for-pl-300-manage-and-secure-power-bi>

Optional visual

LAST VERIFICATION

Live sources checked 2026-09-11. Microsoft's Practice Assessment page states assessments are free, repeatable, include rationales/score reports and are not a replacement for training/product experience. Re-check again immediately before exam payment.